

"NO DOUBT ABOUT IT"

A Dramatic Monologue as Thomas the Apostle

Performer: Carlson Sahlan

School: Cherish Academy

Event: Platform Division — Expressive Reading

Character: Thomas (Doubting Thomas) — Biblical character and setting

Scripture: John 20:24–29 | John 14:21 | Jeremiah 29:13

Time Limit: 4 – 6 minutes

Prop: One nail (hand-held)

INTRODUCTION

(spoken before the monologue — does not count toward time)

*My name is Carlson Sahlan, representing Cherish Academy.
The monologue I will present today is titled "No Doubt About It."
I will be portraying Thomas, one of the twelve disciples of Jesus Christ,
as recorded in John chapter 20, verses 24 through 29.*

THE MONOLOGUE

(Thomas stands center stage, holding the nail. He ponders it, then looks at the audience.)

Have you ever had doubts about something?
I don't mean just everyday uncertainties.

I mean the gut-wrenching fear that you put your faith in something that was just smoke and mirrors?

It's the realization that you were
(passionately) willing to DIE for something,
(pauses, quieter) but then dread that it wasn't real after all.

Well, you aren't alone.
That's exactly what happened to me.

I was one of the twelve; a follower of Jesus.
And, boy, I was all in! Even ready to die beside Him.
Me!

(self-deprecating)

The "Realist," ready to jump into the fire with Jesus.
Hard to believe, right?

(reminiscent)

Once, Jesus wanted us to go back to Judea when his friend, Lazarus, got sick.
The other disciples quickly reminded Jesus that we had just left
because He was almost stoned by the Jews.
I told the others that we should go with Jesus and die right beside Him!

We didn't die on that journey and, instead,
I saw Lazarus raised from the dead.
What a miracle!
You would think that would be proof enough of Jesus' power, right?

(voice fades, broken)

I was all in.

(pauses, becomes even more solemn)

And then He died
and suddenly everything I thought I knew seemed to be false.

The Man who said He was my Savior...
my Teacher...

(pauses)

my friend.
He was gone.

It wasn't an easy death.
He was tortured. Humiliated.
Made to wear a crown of thorns.
They took His clothing. They whipped Him.
And nailed Him to that ugly cross

(holds up nail and looks at it)

They put a spear in His side.
Nails pierced those hands that had only recently washed my feet.
His own mother, crying on her knees, in the crowd.
And then He took His final breath...

(unable to finish — then yelling)

You see He **DIED!**

(pleading)

So, you could see why I was full of doubt, right?
I lost hope that day.

(grows quiet)

I was so lost. We all were.

(shakes himself out of the melancholy memory)

Jesus was placed in a borrowed tomb.
And we were all scared and hiding in an upper room.

I had left the other disciples for a little while and,
when I returned, something had obviously changed.
They were excitedly shouting,
"We have seen the Lord."

Seen the Lord?

(shakes head emphatically, angry — the next lines grow increasingly louder)

No! He was dead. It's impossible. I won't believe
until I place my fingers in Jesus' wounds;
until I touch the place where
THE NAIL (holds up nail again) tore His skin...
where the spear gouged His side.
Only then, will I believe!

(pauses, quieter)

I was so jealous.
You see, whatever had happened in that room, I had missed it.

If Jesus really overcame death and returned to us,
why wouldn't He wait for ME before He revealed Himself to the other disciples?
Doesn't He care about me?

(pauses)

If you've ever asked yourself this question, I hope my story helps you.

Because 8 days later, Jesus returned to that upper room
and I was there this time.

(smiles, remembering)

I'm still convinced that He came just for me.

He called me to His side and told me to put my finger in His wounds.
I reached out and...

"My Lord and my God."

That's what I said as soon as I touched those scars.
It was Him and, in that very moment, He restored me.

You see, some people think that my story is about doubt and fear,
but I hope you see it's so much more than that.

It's another beautiful picture of Jesus' love for His children;
for me and for you.

He didn't leave me in my miserable doubt.
I WANTED to believe. I LONGED to believe.
But I couldn't do it on my own.

Jesus came back to repair my broken faith.
And He'll do the same for you if you're looking for Him...

because Jesus doesn't abandon people who seek Him.
He leaves the 99 to find the one lost sheep.

Are you struggling with doubt?
Doubt of Jesus' resurrection.
Doubt that He died for you.
Doubt of His love.

Look for Him.

There's no doubt, you won't be doubting long.

(lights down)

John 20:24-29 | John 14:21 | Jeremiah 29:13
